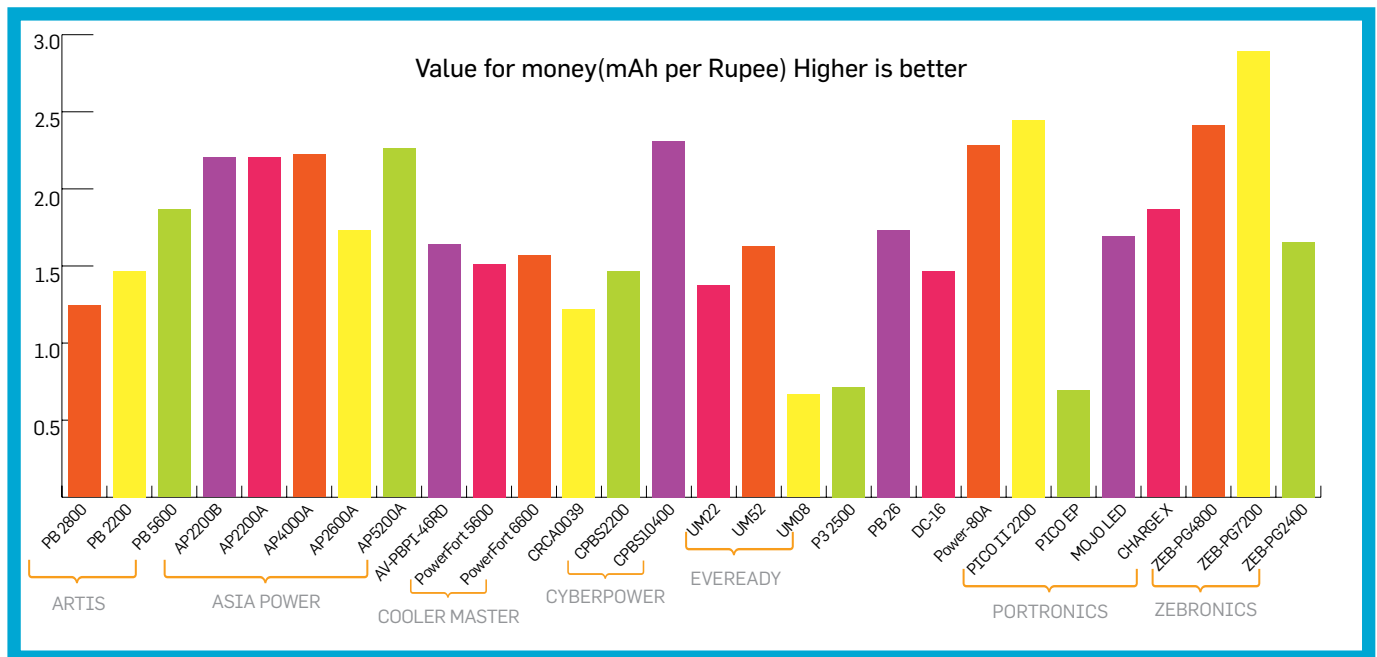


LG's foray into tablets

LG unveiled its 8.3-inch Android 4.2 Jellybean tablet, G Pad before IFA 2013
<http://dgit.in/18wCnQR>

I'm Shakti safety app

I'm Shakti' Android app for women and children's safety released
<http://dgit.in/199FBet>



Extra features

There were a few products that had extra features which we found to be worth mentioning. Four power banks that we tested had an inbuilt torch. While not all of them were bright and focused enough to pass off as proper torches there was one exception – the Portronics Mojo Charger LED. Not only did it have a really bright focused LED and but it also featured 4 modes, which are normal, bright, fast blink and slow blink. The Cooler Master PowerFort 5600 came with a

stylus! This isn't completely out of context but it did surprise us. Other than the torch functionality and the stylus there was no power bank with any special feature worth highlighting. There was the MAXX smart charger which was the only one to mention what brand of battery it had inside but other than that it was just another ordinary power bank. Same goes for the Croma CRCA0039 which was just another average power bank that did what it claimed to without standing out at all. The Eveready UM22

and the Portronics Emergency Power are pretty compact and lightweight which should make them ideal for carrying around in pockets.

The best battery?

Lithium and alkaline are pretty much at the top of the ladder when it comes to battery capacity and longevity. They also offer the most recharge cycles, however, you don't have much choice when power banks are concerned since all of them use either Lithium or Lithium polymer batteries. They have a steady rate of charge and none of them possess the ability to turbo-charge batteries. There have been a few prototypes designed which are capable of very high current input and output but these have only recently stepped out of the laboratory and are yet to become mainstream.

Needless to say, using a power bank

capable of turbo-charge with a device that does not support turbo charge is a futile venture.

Tesla, the electric car company is currently working on batteries which should charge in the same time it takes to fill up a gas/petrol tank (we're talking about car batteries here). So a similar technology when adopted on a smaller scale could change the battery market's dynamic completely. Let's wait and see.

Final words

We saw some great products this year from compact units providing one smart phone charge cycle to mammoth bricks capable of lasting six charge cycles. When we get back to testing this product category next year we should hopefully (with a little extra time and goading) overcome the hurdles we had this time and bring you an actual technical test. Till then the ready reckoner we've given should be more than sufficient at picking out a power bank for your needs.

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